ISSUE 01

Week of 19–25 Oct 2026

The Wild MARKETING DUMP

₹0 *cheaper than your CAC*

Last week in marketing. Unfiltered.

ADS NOW COME WITH EPISODES p.3
Saas-bahu just got a sponsor.

META CALLED. IT WANTS ITS RENT. p.10
70% of D2C brands have the same landlord.

WHY DOES YOUR CHEESE NEED A PASSPORT? p.8
Desi cheese has entered the chat.

IN THIS DUMP

03 **THE BIG ONE**
Ads now come with episodes — P.3

04 **THE DUMP**
6 stories, 6 takes — P.4–5

06 **CAMPAIGN OF THE WEEK**
Heineken made pubs bingeable — P.6–7

08 **WILD BRAND IDEA**
KULTURE, Indian cheese for Indians — P.8–9

10 **NUMBER OF THE WEEK**
One platform, one landlord — P.10

11 **INDIAN BRAND WATCH**
Rockets, mithai and ghee memes — P.11

12 **STEAL THIS × WILD GYAAN**
Keep the asset, change the wrapper — P.12

THE BIG ONE

ADS NOW COME WITH EPISODES

Godrej, Glow & Lovely and Maaza all dropped micro-dramas in one week.



GODREJ

"2nd Gen Kumars": 8 two-minute episodes. The home is the hero, the products just live in it.

GLOW & LOVELY

"Saas, Bahu aur Magic" on ShareChat and Moj. A body swap, one variant per character.

MAAZA

"Don't Go Na": a 7-episode romance at a Diwali party, by Ogilvy.

Not a fad yet: JK Super Cement ran **53 episodes**. TikTok's "Screen Time" crossed **~580 million views**.

MY TAKE

Honestly? Most of these are ads with episode numbers. Delete the logo. Would you still watch episode 2? If yes, you made a show.

AFAQS! 23 & 16 OCT · EXCHANGE4MEDIA · MARKETING DIVE

THE DUMP

What happened, and what I think.

1 MYNTRA'S AD BILL IS ITS BIGGEST COST

₹2,326 crore in FY26: 41% of expenses, 1.9x its ad income. Revenue down 13.5%.

> *1.9x, wait what! That is not marketing, that's literally buying demand :)*

2 D2C GOES BACK TO TV

CaratLane, Swiss Beauty and Dabur's digital brands are buying TV. CaratLane: awareness +54%, consideration +150%.

> *Everyone said TV is dead, but turns out Instagram reach is not enough if you want to capture your next million consumers.*

3 CELEBRITY TV ADS FELL 17%

Jan–Sep, per TAM AdEx. Akshay Kumar alone is in 35 brands.

> *Akshay is in 35 brands. Name five. See? That's exactly why it's falling.*

THE DUMP, CONT'D

AI is doing the ads. Brands are doing less.

4 META'S AI IS SELLING THE ADS

Q3 ad revenue up 26% to $63.1 bn. Nearly 10 million advertisers used its AI creative tools.

> *Meta writes the ad, picks the audience, sets the bid. So what's left for you? The idea. Only the idea.*

5 COCA-COLA: 400+ BRANDS TO ~170

It dropped "brand love" for a behavioural metric and moved North American media to Omnicom.

> *Even Coke is saying no to its own brands. And we're launching a new SKU every month.*

6 GEMINI LEARNS YOUR BRAND KIT

Upload your website, fonts and colours, and it makes visuals in your style and remembers them.

> *On-brand is free now. Knowing what your brand actually stands for? Still not free.*

BESTMEDIAINFO 21–22 OCT · MARKETING DIVE · EXCHANGE4MEDIA 23 OCT

CAMPAIGN OF THE WEEK

PUBSCRIPTION

Heineken made pubs bingeable.



WHAT THEY DID

With Amazon's Brand Innovation Lab, Heineken sorted UK pubs into "genres" by vibe, so you browse them like TV shows, even on Fire TV. Members get free weekly pints.

MARKETING WEEK, 20 OCT

CAMPAIGN OF THE WEEK

38%

of 2,000 people said they'd go out more if finding a pub were as easy as finding a new series.

THE INSIGHT

People weren't short of pubs. They were tired of choosing one.

THE MOVE

Borrow the interface people already open every night, and package the choice like a show.

HOW IT WORKS

1

PICK A VIBE

Pubs sorted into "genres", like shows.

2

BROWSE IT

Scroll pubs like a streaming app, even on Fire TV.

3

FREE PINTS

Members get a free pint every week until 6 Jan 2027.

WHY I PICKED IT

Because choosing a pub is harder than drinking in one. They didn't sell beer, they sold the decision. Total cheat code.

HEINEKEN POLL VIA MARKETING WEEK

WILD BRAND IDEA

WHY MOST CHEESE IN OUR FRIDGE IS STILL IMPORTED IN 2026?

Cheddar, Gouda, Parmesan... bro.

CATEGORY

Cheese. An aisle full of imports, and processed slices on everything: sandwich, Maggi, pizza.

WHITE SPACE

India makes more milk than anyone. Jammu, Bengal and the Himalayas already make cheese. **Never heard of them? Exactly.**



MEET KULTURE.

Real cheese, from the places that invented it.

THE RANGE

KALARI

The mozzarella of Jammu. Pan-fry it or melt it on your pizza.

BANDEL

Smoky and salty. Crumble it on your pasta or your salad.

CHHURPI

The Himalayan hard cheese. Snack on it like a protein bar.

THE LAUNCH

KULTURE SHOCK: a blindfolded taste test, imported vs KULTURE. The reactions are the campaign.



POSITIONING

KULTURE: INDIAN CHEESE FOR INDIANS.

NUMBER OF THE WEEK

70%+

OF INDIAN D2C BRANDS RELY ON META AS THEIR MAIN WAY TO FIND CUSTOMERS.

41% track customer lifetime value as a primary metric

62% of founders say creative fatigue is a bottleneck

MY TAKE

70% on one platform isn't a strategy, yaar, it's putting all your eggs in one basket and praying the algorithm doesn't change. Else you're doomed.

DSG CONSUMER PARTNERS VIA BESTMEDIAINFO, 23 OCT

INDIAN BRAND WATCH

Five moves worth stealing.



KINDER JOY

Rocket and anar-shaped Diwali packs, ₹100–500.



MAYBELLINE

Shades named Berry Barfi, Rose Rabdi and Nutty Halwa.



QUAKER

Protein Ladooz and Chikki Bites at ₹10.



SILVER COIN ATTA

On four Colors shows at once, each with a different job.



GOWARDHAN GHEE

A paid KBC line became a Saif Ali Khan meme.

THE PATTERN

Small desi insights to drive more occasions and relevance.

KEEP THE ASSET. CHANGE THE WRAPPER.

Nerolac's 1990 jingle, remixed by Yashraj Mukhate.



WILD GYAAN · DISTINCTIVE BRAND ASSETS

The cues besides your name that make people think of you: a sound, a line, a colour, a character. Imperial Blue's new owner kept "Men Will Be Men" and the gazelle sound. Years to build, one rebrand to lose.

1

LIST IT

What do people still remember? A tune, a line, a colour.

2

FREEZE IT

That part never gets "refreshed".

3

HAND IT OVER

Give everything else to a new voice or format.

THAT'S THE DUMP.

See you next Monday.

MARKETING WEATHER

↑	↓	‼
RISING	**COOLING**	**STORMY**
Brand micro-dramas	Celebrity TV ads	D2C's Meta habit

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Wild Brand Ideas & Stories for you!